"I'll never be able to trust anyone again."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After betrayal by a spouse, friend, parent, or church, trust feels dangerous. We learn to scan for signs, hold back, and avoid vulnerability. Protecting ourselves makes sense, but if the vow becomes "never," we can end up isolated, protected from pain and also from healing.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not call us to naive trust. "The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps." It also says, "Trust in the LORD with all your heart." God can be trusted perfectly, and people can be trusted in proportion to their character. God promises to heal: "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds." And speaking of a wounded people, "I will allure her... and speak to her tenderly. There I will... make the Valley of Achor into a gateway of hope." Trust can be rebuilt slowly, with wisdom.

> *"Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding"* (Proverbs 3:5).

Also see

> "The simple man believes every word, but the prudent man watches his steps" (Proverbs 14:15).

> "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds" (Psalm 147:3).

> "'Therefore, behold, I will allure her and lead her to the wilderness, and speak to her tenderly. There I will give back her vineyards and make the Valley of Achor into a gateway of hope. There she will respond as she did in the days of her youth, as in the day she came up out of Egypt.'" (Hosea 2:14–15).

> "Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: 'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!'" (Isaiah 43:1).

Common self-statements

- I will never let anyone close again.
- Everyone will let me down.
- It is safer to rely only on myself.
- I cannot read people anymore.
- I was a fool to trust.
- I will always expect the worst.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating one betrayal as proof about everyone.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must trust completely or not at all.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be betrayed.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding that trust is dangerous.

Challenging questions

- What exactly happened, and what did I learn about warning signs?

- Have I known trustworthy people before and since?
- What does trust in small steps look like, as opposed to all or nothing?
- What would be a wise first step to trust someone a little?
- What does God say about trusting Him as I heal?
- What do I need to heal first?

Truth summary

> Trust can be rebuilt wisely, step by step. I do not have to trust everyone, and I do not have to trust no one. I can trust God fully, trust people in proportion to their character, and let Him heal my heart.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Hardship
- Divorce
- Forgiveness
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Broken Things — Matthew West
God can work through imperfect people without waiting for them to become flawless.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll never be able to trust anyone again"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll never be able to trust anyone again." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What happened?
- ☐ What warning signs did I learn?
- ☐ Who is trustworthy?
- ☐ What small step can I take?
- ☐ What does God say about healing?
- ☐ What do I need first?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The prudent watch their steps.
- ☐ I can trust God fully.
- ☐ Trust can be earned in small steps.
- ☐ God heals the brokenhearted.
- ☐ A gateway of hope can open.
- ☐ Not everyone is the one who hurt me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 3:5**
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding."
- ☐ **Psalm 147:3**
  "He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds."
- ☐ **Hosea 2:14–15**
  "'Therefore, behold, I will allure her and lead her to the wilderness, and speak to her tenderly. There I will give back her vineyards and make the Valley of Achor into a gateway of hope. There she will respond as she did in the days of her youth, as in the day she came up out of Egypt.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Small, wise trust: Each week, note one small act of trust and the result.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 3:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I trust the Lord fully, and I can trust people wisely and slowly.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Learn from it. Write what warning signs you can recognize next time.
- ☐ List trustworthy qualities. Write what consistency, honesty, and kindness look like.
- ☐ Test small. Share a small thing with a person who shows these qualities.
- ☐ Seek healing. Consider counseling to process the betrayal.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll never be able to trust anyone again": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A small step of trust
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll never be able to trust anyone again.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I was deeply hurt. Heal my heart, give me wisdom to discern, and teach me to trust You fully. Lead me to people who are safe, and help me risk trust again in small steps. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.